ALPENGRENDEL

Brute Born of Mountain Ice

Large Giant

SECRET
Aversion to Faith

Alpengrendel fear and resent the power of the gods. Their disdain for deities runs so deep that alpengrendel are enraged and unnerved by the trappings of faith. They have disadvantage on attack rolls while in a consecrated area or on attack rolls against a creature holding or wearing a Holy Symbol.

Skill: DC 16 History
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Monastery Archives, Mountain Hermits, Local Hunters

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BAT HOUND

Bloodthirsty Hunter of the Night

Medium Monstrosity

SECRET
Barred by Water

Running water keeps bat hounds at bay and can destroy them, a lingering remnant from the vampiric curse that spawned them. They can't willingly move into running water or to a space up to 20 feet above running water. If a bat hound starts its turn in running water, it takes 10 acid damage and is frightened until the start of its next turn.

Skill: DC 11 Arcana
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Scriptoriums, Village Church Records, Kennelmasters, Vampire Hunters

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BAYOU BEAST

Spirit Hex-Bound to the Swamp

Large Elemental

SECRET
Spirits Susceptibility

A bayou beast's jinxcraft seals can be washed away with alcohol, hindering and even destroying it. The bayou beast takes 9 (2d8) force damage for every bottle of alcohol splashed onto it, and its speed is reduced to 0 until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Arcana
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Hag Huts, Bayou Distilleries, Local Fisherfolk, Village Elders

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BONEFLAYER

Voracious Carrion Eater

Large Monstrosity

SECRET
Thunderous Ward

A lingering result of the fey bargain that created them, boneflayers are disoriented and diminished by loud, thunderous noises. When the boneflayer hears a drum or gong, or takes thunder damage, it has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Arcana
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Fey Ruins, Cult Bonfire Sites, Traveling Druids, Desert Nomads

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BOOGLESWARM

Tricksy Tooth Faeries

Large Swarm of Tiny Fey

SECRET
Sweet Tooth

Boogleswarms go wild for sugar, whether pure or in heavily sweet foods like candy, and are compelled to take and consume any they find. If a swarm can see or smell sugar at the start of its turn, it must use all its movement to move closer to the sugar. If it reaches the sugar, the swarm is incapacitated until the end of its turn as it consumes the sugar. Boogleswarms are only compelled in this way once per short or long rest.

Skill: DC 12 Arcana
Study: 2 Hours
Source: Apothecaries, Sweetshops, Communal Kitchens, Merchants, Street Urchins

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CENTIPEDE HAG

Hag of Pestilence and Flesh-Shaping

Medium Fey

SECRET
Scoured Filth

Centipede hags draw more than strength from the filth that covers them; it is the essence of their being. Scrubbing it away dissolves the hag. Treat a bucket or flask of soapy water splashed on the hag as a vial of acid. If the hag is fully immersed in soapy water at the start of its turn, it takes 20 acid damage.

Skill: DC 20 Arcana
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Soapmakers' Workshops, Alchemical Labs, Traveling Herbalists

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CORVODAEMON

Demon of Hunger and Secrets

Medium Fiend (Demon)

SECRET
Ashen Forbiddance

Savvy demon hunters bar corvodaemons with warding lines of ash prepared from feathers. They can't cross a line of ashes created by burning feathers sprinkled with Holy Water.

Skill: DC 14 Religion
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Temples, Celestial Libraries, Fletchers, Demon Hunters

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CRIMSON CLERGY

Vampiric Zealot

Medium or Small Undead (Cleric, Vampire)

SECRET
Self-Loathing

The crimson clergy struggles to come to terms with how monstrous they have become. They can't stand the sight of themselves and see their true visage in their reflection. A member of the crimson clergy has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls if it can see its reflection.

Skill: DC 13 Religion
Study: 3 Hours
Source: Source: Monasteries, Occult Libraries, Vampire Hunters, Vampires

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Crooked Effigy

Splinter of Crooked Power

Medium Plant

SECRET
Old Bindings

Crooked effigies are bound to the Old Ways, and they recoil from the tools of forging and tinkering—symbols of a growing civilization. An effigy takes an extra 10 force damage if it's hit by an attack roll using Smiths Tools or Tinker's Tools (treat as a Club or Light Hammer).

Skill: DC 12 Nature
Study: 2 Hours
Source: Forest Shrines, Fey Scholars

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CROOKED MAN

Broken Spirit of Betrayal

Medium Undead

SECRET
Aversion to Self-Sacrifice

The crooked man can't abide self-sacrifice and withers in its presence. He takes 20 necrotic damage if he can see a creature willingly take damage or gain a condition in place of someone else, or to someone else's benefit.

Skill: DC 24 Religion
Study: 14 Hours
Source: Catacombs, Sacrificial Altars, Executioners, Hags, Troubadours

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CROWSTORM

Fiendish Murder

Large Swarm of Tiny Fiends (Demon)

SECRET
False Crows

While they might take the form of crows, crowstorms are held at bay by drawn images or crafted effigies of crows. A crowstorm swarm can't enter a space containing such an image or effigy, and a creature holding one has advantage on saving throws forced by the swarm.

Skill: DC 13 Religion
Study: 3 Hours
Source: Aviaries, Menageries, Falconers, Demonologists

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DEEPDRECK

Poisoned Subterranean Wretch

Medium Monstrosity

SECRET

Fragrance Aversion

The toxic essence of deepdregs is disrupted by pleasant scents such as flowers, perfume, spices, or incense. They have disadvantage on attack rolls and saving throws while within 10 feet of burning incense or a creature wearing perfume.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Miners' Guilds, Perfumeries, Apothecaries, Dungeon Delvers, Subterranean Merchants

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DRAKKENHOB

Dragon Disguised as a Festival Horse

Large Dragon

SECRET
Irresistible Payment

Unable to resist revelry and merriment, drakkenhob are driven away by payment offered in gold or alcohol. A creature that offers the drakkenhob alcohol or any amount of gold and succeeds on a DC 16 Charisma (Persuasion) check forces the drakkenhob to accept the offer and immediately use its reaction to move up to half its speed to get away from the creature by the safest route possible.

Skill: DC 19 Nature
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Festival Ledgers, Taverns, Merchant Guilds, Traveling Performers, Carnival Workers

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Dream Eater

Devourer of Dreams and Minds

Large Monstrosity

SECRET
Moth Ward

Dream eaters are confused by the intricate patterns on moth wings, and it disrupts their own colorful hypnosis. A creature holding a moth's wing automatically succeeds on saving throws against the dream eater's Hypnotic Wings, without needing to make an ability check.

Skill: DC 20 Arcana
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Seers' Circles, Sleepwalkers

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FERRYMAN

Cursed Undead Boatman

Medium Undead

SECRET
Payment

Paying a ferryman 3 copper coins lifts any curse the creature placed on the payer, and it entitles one to a single unnerving but safe ride in the ferryman's coffin boat. If the boat is full, the ferryman must return to offer the creature a ride once its current passengers leave the boat.

Skill: DC 16 Religion
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Swamp Settlements, Bayou Hermits, Undertakers

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FESTERHULK

Fungal Undead Giant

Huge Undead

SECRET
Sunlight Hypersensitivity

Festerhulks shrink from sunlight, which harms the fungus that animates them. They take 10 radiant damage if they start its turn in sunlight. While in sunlight, it has disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

Skill: DC 21 Religion
Study: 11 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Mountain Hermits, Herbalists

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FLESHDOBBIN

Flesh-Crafted Amalgam of Knight and Horse

Large Monstrosity

SECRET
Bridle Binding

Affixing a bridle to a fleshdobbin causes the instincts of the horse within the amalgam to take over, becoming a loyal steed once more. If a creature puts a bridle on the fleshdobbin (treat as securing manacles), the fleshdobbin is charmed while it wears the bridle, and it can't take the bridle off on its own.

Skill: DC 16 Arcana
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Stronghold Archives, Chivalric Orders, Hags, Battlefield Scavengers

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Gloomwood

Blighted Treant

Huge Plant

SECRET
Carved Past

Carving the Sylvan name of the forest the gloomwood once called home into its trunk quells its aggression. As an action, a creature can use a dagger or woodcarver's tools to carve the name. Until the gloomwood finishes a long rest, it can't use its Fungal Fling or Spore Stomp actions.

Skill: DC 20 Nature
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Druidic Circles, Forest Hermits, Fey Scholars

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GOBBLEGEIST

Blood-Drinking Avian Predator

Huge Monstrosity

SECRET
Repelled by Stars

The folk who venerate the Old Ways believe that a seven-pointed star repels gobblegeists. They keep the monsters at bay by painting star sigils or weaving them from wicker to hang from their homes or in trees. A gobblegeist can't willingly move to a space within 10 feet of a seven-pointed star drawn on a surface or woven from wicker.

Skill: DC 18 Arcana
Study: 8 Hours
Source: Taverns, Shepherds, Followers of the Old Ways

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HERALD OF FOOLS

Leader of Fiendish Revels

Medium Fiend

SECRET
Endless Footwork

Heralds of fools are wonderful dancers, and they must never stop dancing, or they quickly perish. When the herald's speed is 0, attack rolls made against it have advantage, and if its speed is 0 at the start of its turn, it takes 20 necrotic damage.

Skill: DC 20 Religion
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Festivals, Dance Halls, Theaters, Traveling Performers, Bards

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HOSPITAL HORROR

Mutated Experiment

Medium Aberration

SECRET

Aversion to Needles

Hospital horrors have spent much of their existence being prodded with needles, so being pierced frays what few wits they retain. If the horror takes piercing damage, it has disadvantage on attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 11 Arcana
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Sanitorium Records, Surgical Theaters, Doctors, Surgeons

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HOUSE OF HORROR

Cursed House Brought to Malevolent Life

Gargantuan Construct

SECRET
Exorcism Susceptibility

While not haunted houses in the traditional sense, houses of horror can have their consciousness quelled by the same exorcism or purification rituals that put unquiet spirits to rest or drive out possessing spirits. If the house is targeted by the *Dispel Evil and Good* spell, it is stunned. At the end of each of its turns, the house can make a DC 15 Charisma saving throw, ending the condition on a success. The condition also ends after 1 minute. A creature inside the house can also throw a flask of holy water at the house and make a DC 20 Charisma check. On a success, the house is affected as though targeted by the *Dispel Evil and Good* spell.

Skill: DC 23 Arcana
Study: 13 Hours
Source: Town Archives, Taverns, Arcane Colleges, Ghost Hunters

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HYPNOVULFEN

Hungry Hypnotizing Wolf

Large Monstrosity

SECRET
Hypnotic Gaze

Hypnovulfen have no power to mesmerize anyone holding a keepsake or memento received from a loved one, as it overpowers the false beckoning of the monster's gaze. A creature holding such a keepsake succeeds saving throws against its Hypnotic Gaze automatically.

Skill: DC 25 Arcana
Study: 15 Hours
Source: Hunter Lodges, Hermitages, Traveling Storytellers, Antiquity Dealers

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INVADER OUT OF SPACE

Intruder From Beyond the Stars

Medium Abberation

SECRET
Weak Constitution

Invaders have little resilience to the toxic and virulent threats of the Material Plane, and they succumb quickly to diseases and poisons. An invader has disadvantage on saving throws to avoid or end the poisoned condition. If the invader is poisoned at the start of its turn, it takes 20 necrotic damage.

Skill: DC 21 Arcana
Study: 11 Hours
Source: Arcane Colleges, Astronomers, Planar Scholars

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KACKLE

Laughing Lantern Bearer

Medium Undead

SECRET
Lantern Vulnerability

Kackles are bound to their lanterns, and smashing their lights can snuff out the spirits' existence. The kackle's lantern has AC 15 and immunity to poison and psychic damage. Any damage the lantern takes deals an equal amount of force damage to the kackle.

Skill: DC 17 Religion
Study: 7 Hours
Source: Cemeteries, Undertakers, Lanternmakers, Ghost Hunters

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KEEPER OF THE BLIGHT

Druid Transformed by Blight

Large Fey (Druid)

SECRET
Blight Dependent

The fungus growing throughout keepers of the blight empowers and sustains them, and killing that growth diminishes their power. If the keeper is targeted by an effect that ends the poisoned condition, it takes 10 (3d6) force damage and has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Arcana
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Arboretums, Forest Hermits, Apothecaries

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KETGRINN

Voice-Stealing Trickster

Medium Fey

SECRET
Riddle Bound

A ketgrinn can't resist a puzzle or riddle, and a particularly challenging one can overwhelm its mind. As an action, a creature can pose a riddle to the ketgrinn and make a DC 16 Charisma (Deception) check. On a success, the ketgrinn is incapacitated until the start of the creature's next turn. Each time a riddle is posed, the DC increases by 1 for 24 hours.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Menageries, Illusionists' Guilds, Puzzlemakers, Fey Scholars

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LAKE DREDGER

Undead Aquatic Monster

Huge Undead

SECRET
Depicted Demise

Lake dredgers exist because of the fear of the unknown, and their essence is undone in the presence of a captured or crafted depiction of themselves, such as a drawing or carving. It takes 20 force damage at the start of its turn if it can see a creature holding a depiction of the lake dredger.

Skill: DC 19 Religion
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Sunken Temples, Shipwrecks, Deepwater Salvagers, Sailors

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Lurker in the Dark

Thing That Goes Bump in the Night

Medium Fey

SECRET
Ward of Innocence

Frightened children know that lurkers in the dark can be held at bay by clutching a beloved stuffed animal. The lurker can't attack or willingly move to a space within 10 feet of a creature holding a stuffed animal once owned by a child.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Urban Legends, Childrens' Tales, Toymakers, Paranormal Investigators

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MAIDENWOOD

Witch-Warped Ambushing Tree

Huge Plant

SECRET
Undoing Gift

The curse that sustains a maidenwood unravels if it is offered an apple—an ancient trick once used by witches. A maidenwood must accept and eat an apple offered to it or its lure. When it does, the maidenwood takes 55 (10d10) poison damage and is poisoned for 1 minute.

Skill: DC 19 Nature
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Orchardist, Witch Covens, Fey Scholars

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MUTANT NURSE

Caregiver Twisted by Mutation

Medium Abberation

SECRET

Anchoring Mask

Mutant nurses go berserk if their masks are destroyed or taken from them, or they become unresponsive if there are no other creatures nearby. Each mutant nurse wears a porcelain mask (AC 15, 15 hit points, immunity to poison and psychic damage). If the nurse starts its turn without its mask, it must move as far as it can toward the closest creature it can see or hear and attack it. If it can't see or hear any other creatures, it either immobilizes and does nothing, or it destroys any objects in its vicinity (50 percent chance of either).

Skill: DC 13 Arcana
Study: 3 Hours
Source: Sanatorium Records, Apothecaries, Alchemical Labs, Occult Anatomists, Healers

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NECROLISK

Subterranean Spirit-Devouring Drake

Huge Dragon

SECRET
Herb Allergy

Necrolisks are severely allergic to a concoction of lavender, nightshade, and lilies, which causes them to vomit uncontrollably—a boon to anyone swallowed by the monsters. If a necrolisk eats a specific concoction of herbs worth 25 GP (such as if a swallowed creature pours them into its stomach as an action), at the end of the turn, the necrolisk regurgitates anything in its stomach as if it failed the saving throw described in its Swallow bonus action.

Skill: DC 20 Nature
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Cathedral Archives, Gravekeepers, Tomb Robbers, Herbalists

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NIGHT CREATURE

Bestial Vampiric Blood Hunter

Large Fiend

SECRET
Salt Susceptibility

Night creatures are quickly undone by the purity of salt if wiped on a weapon and driven into a wound. They have vulnerability to damage from weapons wiped with salt. A creature can use a bonus action to wipe salt onto a weapon, which remains coated for 1 minute.

Skill: DC 14 Religion
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Scriptoriums, Vampiric Covens, Vampire Hunters, Apothecaries

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Old Ways Chosen

Devout Follower of Old Gods

Medium or Small Humanoid

SECRET
Animal Mask

Old ways chosen bind their power into a mask they use as a focus. Without the mask, the chosen can't cast spells, and its concentration on existing spells ends. A creature grappling the chosen can use an action to attempt to remove the mask by succeeding on a DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check, or attempt to remove the mask as part of an attack by replacing one of its attacks during the Attack action.

Skill: DC 15 History
Study: 5 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Followers of the Old Ways, Hermits

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PHANTOM HEARSE

Ghostly Coach of the Dead

Huge Undead

SECRET
Breathless Warding

Phantom hearses are driven to collect the living, and they can't see a living creature that holds its breath. A creature holding its breath is invisible to the hearse. If the creature takes damage while holding its breath, it must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or let out its breath and become visible to the hearse until the start of the creature's next turn, when it can hold its breath again.

Skill: DC 19 Religion
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Sepulchral Libraries, Historical Societies, Funeral Parlors, Gravekeepers, Ghost Hunters

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PIGEON HAG

Vermin Hag of Deception and Control

Medium Fey

SECRET
Disarming Vanity

The vanity of a pigeon hag is so overwhelming that flattering it can leave it flustered and unable to act. As an action, a creature can flatter the hag, forcing it to make a DC 17 Charisma saving throw. On a failed save, the hag is incapacitated until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 23 Arcana
Study: 13 Hours
Source: Aviaries, Witch Covens, Messenger Guilds, Fey Scholars

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PUMPKIN HEAD

Fiendish Effigy of the Fields

Medium Fiend

SECRET

Sorrowful Memento

Pumpkin heads hold a shred of memory from the people they replaced. The sight of a keepsake or memento from victim confuses the creature. If the pumpkin head can see a creature holding a possession of the person the pumpkin head replaced, it has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls.

Skill: DC 13 Religion
Study: 3 Hours
Source: Harvest Festivals, Farmers, Hedge Witches, Infernal Grimoirs

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Reveler of Song

Fiend of Music and Dance (Droning)

Medium Fiend

SECRET
Compelled Contest

Revelers of song can't accept that any creature is more skilled at an instrument than they are and so can't refuse a musical challenge. The reveler can't refuse a contest of skill with musical instruments. As an action, a creature can make a Charisma (Performance) check using a musical instrument. The reveler must make a Charisma saving throw with a DC equal to the check's total. On a failed save, the reveler takes 20 psychic damage and is stunned until the end of the creature's next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Religion
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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Reveler of Song

Fiend of Music and Dance (Drumming)

Medium Fiend

SECRET
Compelled Contest

Revelers of song can't accept that any creature is more skilled at an instrument than they are and so can't refuse a musical challenge. The reveler can't refuse a contest of skill with musical instruments. As an action, a creature can make a Charisma (Performance) check using a musical instrument. The reveler must make a Charisma saving throw with a DC equal to the check's total. On a failed save, the reveler takes 20 psychic damage and is stunned until the end of the creature's next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Religion
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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REVELER OF SONG

Fiend of Music and Dance (Ringing)

Medium Fiend

SECRET
Compelled Contest

Revelers of song can't accept that any creature is more skilled at an instrument than they are and so can't refuse a musical challenge. The reveler can't refuse a contest of skill with musical instruments. As an action, a creature can make a Charisma (Performance) check using a musical instrument. The reveler must make a Charisma saving throw with a DC equal to the check's total. On a failed save, the reveler takes 20 psychic damage and is stunned until the end of the creature's next turn.

Skill: DC 16 Religion
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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Reveler of Stories

Fiend of Legend and Folklore (Great Beast)

Large Fiend

SECRET
Moral Quandary

Revelers of stories exist because of fables, legends, and other tales, and reciting the moral of a story related to the reveler's theme embodiment robs the reveler of its potency. As a bonus action, a creature can recite the moral of a story matching the reveler's Storied Form, weakening it for 1 hour. While weakened, the reveler's AC is reduced by 4, and it can't take reactions.

Skill: DC 19 Religion
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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Reveler of Stories

Fiend of Legend and Folklore (Hero)

Large Fiend

SECRET

Moral Quandary

Revelers of stories exist because of fables, legends, and other tales, and reciting the moral of a story related to the reveler's theme embodiment robs the reveler of its potency. As a bonus action, a creature can recite the moral of a story matching the reveler's Storied Form, weakening it for 1 hour. While weakened, the reveler's AC is reduced by 4, and it can't take reactions.

Skill: DC 19 Religion
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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Reveler of Stories

Fiend of Legend and Folklore (Witch)

Large Fiend

SECRET
Moral Quandary

Revelers of stories exist because of fables, legends, and other tales, and reciting the moral of a story related to the reveler's theme embodiment robs the reveler of its potency. As a bonus action, a creature can recite the moral of a story matching the reveler's Storied Form, weakening it for 1 hour. While weakened, the reveler's AC is reduced by 4, and it can't take reactions.

Skill: DC 19 Religion
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Bardic Colleges, Dance Halls, Performers' Troupes, Taverns, Troubadours

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ROTWEAVER

Fey Thrall of Rot

Medium Fey

SECRET
Iron Binding

The rotweavers' fey nature still holds; binding them with iron, such as manacles or a chain, mutes their strength. If the rotweaver has iron wrapped around a part of its body, such as an iron bracelet, manacles, or chain (treat any of them as applying manacles), the rotweaver can move, take an action, or use its bonus action, but not all three.

Skill: DC 11 Arcana
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Druid Groves, Apothecaries, Hunters' Camps, Hermits, Arborists

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SERUM BRUTE

Cursed Giant Enhanced by Alchemy

Large Giant

SECRET
Curse Dependent

Serum brutes are dependent upon their curses, and magic that breaks curses can leave the giants debilitated and bereft. If the brute is targeted by a *Remove Curse* spell or other magic that ends a curse, the brute loses its Withering Eye trait, Cursed Gaze action, and its blindsight, and it has disadvantage on attack rolls. These effects end when it finishes a long rest.

Skill: DC 16 History
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Sanatorium Records, Apothecaries, Alchemical Labs, Occult Anatomists, Healers

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SHROUDED

Soul Corrupted by the Shroud

Medium Undead

SECRET
Graveyard Warding

Shrouded are bounded by barriers and lines of iron, which is why cemeteries with iron fences keep them contained. The shrouded can't move through a space with a barrier or line of iron, such as a wrought iron fence or a line of iron filings. This impassible barrier rises to a height of 1 mile above the iron.

Skill: DC 14 Religion
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Town Records, Funeral Parlors, Gravekeepers, Ghost Hunters, Folklore Collections

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SKITTERSWARM

Fetid Fey Centipedes

Medium Swarm of Tiny Fey

SECRET
Body Burrowing

Skitterswarms can't resist dead bodies and are drawn to the corpses of humanoids. If the swarm can see such a corpse at the start of its turn, it must move up to its speed toward the corpse. Once it enters the corpse's space, it must remain there for 1 hour, after which time the corpse's flesh putrefies off its bones.

Skill: DC 10 Arcana
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Alchemical Labs, Sickhouses, Rat Catchers, Hags, Gravekeepers, Herbalists

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SOULFIRE STOKER

Engine-Born Spirit of Flame and Death

Medium Elemental

SECRET
Corpse Fuel

Soulfire stokers are compelled to burn corpses they can see, so dead things can bait the spirits. If the elemental can see a corpse at the start of its turn, it must move as far as possible to enter the corpse's space and use its action to incinerate the corpse, reducing it to ash.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Crematoriums, Smithies, Blacksmith Guilds, Engineers, Undertakers

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SQUABSWARM

Peeping Fey Pigeons

Medium Swarm of Tiny Fey

SECRET
Compelled Delivery

Squabswarms' drive to deliver letters or parcels is overwhelming, and they can be confused by delivery requests. As an action, a creature can direct the swarm to deliver a letter or parcel (which the creature must provide) to a recipient the creature knows. The swarm is charmed until it delivers the item to the specified recipient or until it takes damage. While charmed in this way, the swarm must deliver the item to the specified recipient if it knows where the recipient is.

Skill: DC 10 Arcana
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Post Offices, Messenger Guilds, Aviaries, Hag Covens

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Vermin Familiar

Infesting Hag Companion (Centipede)

Tiny Fey

SECRET
Fear of Canines

Vermin familiars are gripped by deep-seated fears shared by the vermin forms they inhabit, and as such, are terrified of dogs and other canines. If the familiar can see a dog, wolf, or other canine at the start of its turn, it becomes frightened until the start of its next turn. While frightened in this way, it has disadvantage on saving throws.

Skill: DC 12 Arcana
Study: 2 Hours
Source: Alchemical Labs, Menageries, Arcane Colleges, Hag Covens

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VERMIN FAMILIAR

Infesting Hag Companion (Pigeon)

Tiny Fey

SECRET
Fear of Canines

Vermin familiars are gripped by deep-seated fears shared by the vermin forms they inhabit, and as such, are terrified of dogs and other canines. If the familiar can see a dog, wolf, or other canine at the start of its turn, it becomes frightened until the start of its next turn. While frightened in this way, it has disadvantage on saving throws.

Skill: DC 12 Arcana
Study: 2 Hours
Source: Alchemical Labs, Menageries, Arcane Colleges, Hag Covens

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Vermin Familiar

Infesting Hag Companion (Weasel)

Tiny Fey

SECRET
Fear of Canines

Vermin familiars are gripped by deep-seated fears shared by the vermin forms they inhabit, and as such, are terrified of dogs and other canines. If the familiar can see a dog, wolf, or other canine at the start of its turn, it becomes frightened until the start of its next turn. While frightened in this way, it has disadvantage on saving throws.

Skill: DC 12 Arcana
Study: 2 Hours
Source: Alchemical Labs, Menageries, Arcane Colleges, Hag Covens

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VERMIN INFESTATION

Swarm of Verminous Familiars

Medium Swarm of Tiny Fey

SECRET
Infighting

The fey spirits that make up a vermin infestation loathe one another and can be tricked into fighting among themselves by a clever suggestion. As an action, a creature can suggest that the swarm's members are conspiring against each other and make a DC 15 Charisma (Deception) check. On a success, the swarm takes 10 necrotic damage.

Skill: DC 13 Arcana
Study: 3 Hours
Source: Arcane Colleges, Historical Societies, Rat Keepers, Hag Covens, Fey Scholars

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WAYWARD HAINT

Lost Soul Bound to Regret

Medium Undead

SECRET
Bottle Trap

Wayward haints can be trapped in empty bottles if tricked or forced to pass over one. When a haint enters the space of an upright, empty bottle, it must succeed on a DC 16 Charisma saving throw or be drawn into the bottle. A cork or stopper appears, sealing the bottle shut. While trapped, the haint can see and hear through the bottle out to a range of 10 feet, and creatures within that range can hear the haint. The haint is released if the bottle breaks or a creature opens it.

Skill: DC 11 Religion
Study: 1 Hour
Source: Arcane Colleges, Historical Societies, Ghost Hunters, Occultists, Spiritual Mediums

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WEASEL HAG

Hag of Soul Twisting and Terror

Medium Fey

SECRET
Biting Gift

Weasel hags' love of teeth goes beyond a mere quirk. They can't refuse a tooth willingly given by its owner and can't harm the owner for a time. If a creature willingly offers one of its teeth to the hag, the hag must accept it and is charmed for 24 hours, or until the creature or its allies deal damage to the hag or force it to make a saving throw.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Arcane Colleges, Urban Legends, Hag Covens, Spiritual Mediums

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WELLWYRM

Serpent Lurking Beneath the Surface

Large Dragon

SECRET

Hunting Terror

The sound of a hunting horn drives wellwyrms into a panicked frenzy. If it hears a creature play a horn or similar musical instrument, it is frightened until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 19 Nature
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Taverns, Gravekeepers, Fisherfolk, Local Hunters, Fey Scholars

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WILDPYRE

Spectral Blazing Beast

Medium or Large Undead

SECRET
Quenching Water

Water can still quench the undying flames of wildpyres, despite their ephemeral existence. Normal water affects them as if it were holy water.

Skill: DC 15 Religion
Study: 5 Hours
Source: Monasteries, Arcane Colleges, Fey Scholars, Ghost Hunters

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WOODWARPED

Facsimile Grown of Root and Vine

Medium Plant

SECRET

Aversion to Axes

Woodwarped possess a deep fear of axes—tools capable of severing not only their bodies but their bond to the forest. The mere sight of an axe is enough to hold the creatures at bay, and the bite of its blade slices them like smoke. At the start of the woodwarped's turn, if it can see a creature holding a battleaxe, a greataxe, or a handaxe, it is frightened until the start of its next turn.

Skill: DC 14 Nature
Study: 4 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Logging Camps, Hedge Witches, Herbalists

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WORMHOST SURGEON

Parasitical Physician

Medium Aberration

SECRET
Sleepless Apathy

Wormhost surgeons are drawn to seek out and infest sapient victims, so intelligent creatures with veiled minds slip beneath the surgeons' notice. A creature whose mind can't be read, or that is under the effect of a *Mind Blank* or *Nondetection* spell, is invisible to the surgeon (this ignores the surgeon's blindsight).

Skill: DC 15 Arcana
Study: 5 Hours
Source: Sanatorium Records, Morgues, Alchemical Labs, Occult Libraries, Healers, Monster Hunters

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THE BEAST OF BLIGHT

Manifestation of Rot and Decay

Gargantuan Fey

SECRET
Unraveled Longing

Buried deep within the Beast of Blight, a tiny fragment of Farryn still exists. If shown an image of her lost love, the ignited memory will burn away the rot. If the beast can see the likeness of its long-lost love at the start of its turn, the beast has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls and takes 10 psychic damage.

Skill: DC 20 Arcana
Study: 10 Hours
Source: Druid Groves, Nature Guardians, Forest Hermits, Blight Survivors

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THE CHAINED REAPER

Burdened Harbinger of Death

Gargantuan Undead

SECRET
Ancestral Shame

The Chained Reaper carries a memorial stone upon its back. If one can read aloud the names inscribed there, their purity will burn away the reaper's fury. As an action, a creature within 30 feet that can speak Orc may read the names carved in the stone on the reaper's back, and the reaper takes 20 radiant damage.

Skill: DC 21 Arcana
Study: 11 Hours
Source: Cemeteries, Gravekeepers, Orc Chieftains

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THE CRIMSON ABBOTT

Unholy Crusader of Blood

Large Undead (Paladin, Vampire)

SECRET
Honor Lost

The Crimson Abbot's pride is nearly unshakable, but seeing a true reminder of the righteous man he once was can crack his façade. As a bonus action, a creature can present a memento or recite a reminder of the abbot's past and make a DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion) check. On a success, the abbot has disadvantage on the next ability check, saving throw, or attack roll he makes before the start of his next turn.

Skill: DC 18 Arcana
Study: 8 Hours
Source: Monasteries, Scriptoriums, Vampiric Circles, Chivalric Orders, Acolytes

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The Ghostlight Locomotive

Corrupted Ghost Train

Gargantuan Construct

Secret

The *Ghostlight Express* sustains its passage through the Shroud by consuming lost spirits transformed into soul coal. The locomotive's survival depends on this relentless cycle, with no alternative fuel to power its journey.

Skill: DC 14 Arcana
Study: 4 Hours
Source: The Vagrant

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The Grinning Sinner

Dealer of Jinxes

Large Humanoid (Lizardfolk, Warlock)

SECRET
Overweening Pride

The Grinning Sinner holds his prowess and reputation as a fearsome and successful pirate captain above all; causing him to doubt his renown can turn his hexed magic against him. As a bonus action, a creature can insult the sinner's skill and renown as a pirate captain. The sinner must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, he takes 10 psychic damage and have disadvantage on attack rolls against any target other than the creature.

Skill: DC 19 Arcana
Study: 9 Hours
Source: Pirate Hideouts, Ship Graveyards, Merchant Guilds, Retired Captains

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THE HARVEST TERROR

Demon of Secrets and Despair

Large Fiend (Demon)

SECRET
Unraveling Song

The soul of Ol' Jericho Sticks still exists in the dark recesses of the Harvest Terror's mind. Singing or playing Jericho's favorite song tips the balance of control over Jericho's stolen body. As an action, a creature can play or sing Jericho Sticks' favorite song, "Coal-Eyed Birds." The terror is charmed until the end of the creature's next turn. The condition ends early if the creature damages the terror or forces it to make a saving throw.

Skill: DC 16 Arcana
Study: 6 Hours
Source: Taverns, Rural Storytellers, Traveling Minstrels

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THE HORNED KING

Sin Made Manifest

Gargantuan Fiend

SECRET

The Horned King feeds on selfishness and sin, growing stronger with each indulgence in temptation. The more mortals surrender to their desires, the greater his power becomes, binding them to his will and drawing him closer to full manifestation.

Skill: DC 27 Arcana
Study: 17 Hours
Source: Repentant Sinners Corrupted By The Horned King

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The Lord of Fools

Fiendish Master of Revels

Huge Fiend

SECRET
Bitter Medicine

The Lord of Fools thrives on laughter and amusement, so when someone doesn't react accordingly to one of his japes, he becomes enraged at that creature to the exclusion of others. As a bonus action, a creature can dismiss or belittle the lord's attempts at humor and make a DC 16 Charisma (Deception) check. On a success, the lord has disadvantage on attack rolls against any target other than that creature until the start of the creature's next turn.

Skill: DC 23 Arcana
Study: 13 Hours
Source: Festivals, Traveling Performers, Old Songbooks

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The Vermintoll Abomination

Verminous Coven Amalgamation

Large Fey

Secret

The Vermintoll Coven's combined magic is formidable. Each hag believes they alone act in true service to the Crooked Queen, viewing her sisters as rivals. This loathing festers within the coven.

Skill: DC 24 Arcana
Study: 14 Hours
Source: Members of the Vermintoll Coven

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The Weeping Widow

Matron of Malevolent Medicine

Medium Abberation

SECRET
Reopened Memories

The only way to force the Weeping Widow to live up to her moniker is to remind her of the family she lost, such as her husband's sword or portrait, which forces her to confront what she has become. At the start of her turn, if the widow can see a memento of her husband or some other reminder that forces her to realize what she's lost, she has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls and can only expend 2 uses of her legendary actions until the start of her next turn.

Skill: DC 18 Arcana
Study: 8 Hours
Source: Sanatoriums, Alchemy Labs, Apothecaries, Clerical Orders, Orderlies

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THE WICKER MAN

Blazing Sacrificial Colossus

Gargantuan Construct

SECRET

The Wicker Man's strength is fueled by the fervor and devotion of its worshippers. If its worship is disrupted, the effigy's power wanes.

Skill: DC 25 Arcana
Study: 15 Hours
Source: Old Ways Chosen

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THE BARROW KING

Undying Conqueror Awaiting Glory

Large Undead

SECRET
Name of Rest

The Barrow King's only true weakness is his name, written in the runic form of his lost native language. The king has AC 10 against attack rolls made with a weapon inscribed with the runic form of his original name, and the king has disadvantage on attack rolls made against a creature holding such a weapon.

Skill: DC 32 Religion
Study: 22 Hours
Source: Catacombs, Forgotten Libraries, Loremasters, Necromancers

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THE BRIMSTONE BEHEMOTH

Cataclysmic Evil

Gargantuan Fiend

SECRET
Burning Sacrifice

If a creature willingly sacrifices its life in fire or lava for the purpose of defeating the Brimstone Behemoth, the creature can't be returned to life by any means and for the next 24 hours the behemoth has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls, its speed is halved, it has vulnerability to radiant damage, and it loses its legendary resistance trait.

Skill: DC 35 Arcana
Study: 25 Hours
Source: Infernal Codices, Planar Scholars, Cults of Flame, Prophets

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THE DUSK MOTHER

Weeping Mother Bound in Death

Large Undead

SECRET
Undeniable Guilt

The Dusk Mother's only true weakness or fear are the true remnants of her children—some trinket or toy of theirs in life, or more chilling, their spirits which also wander the world, but never in the same place as their mother's shade. At the start of her turn, if the Dusk Mother can see a possession once owned by her living children, or can see or hear the spirits of her children, she is incapacitated until the start of her next turn, and must move as far from the object or spirits as possible during her turn.

Skill: DC 34 Arcana
Study: 24 Hours
Source: Manor Houses, Undertakers

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The Galloping Headsman

Undying Executioner

Large Undead

SECRET
Binding Skull

The Galloping Headsman's original skull is its greatest weakness, and anyone holding the skull becomes the apparition's bane. The headsman is vulnerable to any damage dealt by a creature holding the headsman's original skull, and it has disadvantage on ability checks and attack rolls made against that creature.

Skill: DC 28 Arcana
Study: 18 Hours
Source: Taverns, Old Battlefield Cemeteries, Traveling Bards

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THE JINXED LEVIATHAN

Curse-Wrought Murk Monster

Gargantuan Monstrosity

SECRET
Returned Curse

An idol of the fabled deal maker Snake-Eyed Jack that has been blessed by one of Jack's followers can turn the Jinxed Leviathan's own cursed power against it. If the Jinxed Leviathan curses a creature holding an idol of Snake-Eyed Jack blessed by one of that being's devoted followers, the creature is unaffected by the curse. The leviathan then takes 20 radiant damage and has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Skill: DC 33 Arcana
Study: 23 Hours
Source: Sunken Villages, Hermits, Cursed Objects

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THE TALL MAN

Lurking Archfey of Dark Woods

Huge Fey

SECRET

Dancing forgotten steps once seen in the Fey court the Tall Man rules shreds his being. As a bonus action, a creature can perform some steps from a dance of the Tall Man's court and make a DC 20 Charisma (Performance) check. On a success, the Tall Man takes 20 force damage and has disadvantage on ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls until the start of the creature's next turn.

Skill: DC 30 Arcana
Study: 20 Hours
Source: Fey Scholars, Sylvan Songbooks

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THE WHITE WORM

Eldritch Devourer of Memories

Gargantuan Aberration

SECRET
Poisoned Knowledge

A specific series of constellations and star paths through the heavens is a deadly poison to the White Worm. If the White Worm uses Devour Mind on a creature that knows a special sequence of constellations and their path through the sky, at the start of the target's turn the White Worm takes 50 psychic damage and Devour Mind ends.

Skill: DC 29 Arcana
Study: 19 Hours
Source: Observatories, Arcane Colleges, Occultists, Astral Travelers, Celestial Charts

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THE WILD TITAN

Destructive Primal Gargant

Gargantuan Giant

SECRET
Runic Sever

The name of the titan's forgotten creator is its undoing. Recovering the lost name and carving its glyph form into a stone severs the titan's connection to the wild. If the titan starts its turn within 50 feet of a stone at least 10 feet high and 10 feet wide carved with the glyph representing its forgotten creator, the titan takes 50 necrotic damage and is poisoned until the start of its next turn.

Skill: DC 31 Arcana
Study: 21 Hours
Source: Monasteries, Ancient Stone Circles, Nature Guardians, Mountain Hermits, Runestones

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USING THIS DECK

This Monster & Bosses deck is your quick-reference tool for adding depth and mystery to your adventures in *The Crooked Moon*. Each card contains:

MONSTER OVERVIEW. The Name, Size, Type, and Alignment for quick identification.

MONSTER SECRET. A unique trait or vulnerability that can influence roleplay and combat.

SECRET DISCOVERY. The suggested Skill, DC, Study Time and possible Sources where a monster's secret can be found or learned.

The front of each card features art of the monster or boss you can reveal to players (without revealing its secret). The other reference card in this deck includes the basic rules for uncovering monster secrets, which may be shared with players.

Remember, this deck is an aid, not a replacement for the full stat blocks and lore in The Crooked Moon. See Appendix A for the complete rules for monster secrets.

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USING THE DECK

MONSTER SECRETS

Secrets abound in *The Crooked Moon*. Many monsters, creatures, and folk that you meet have hidden quirks or lore that can influence them or turn the tide of battle—if one is able to learn them before it's too late. Here's how to uncover them:

Locate a Source. Find an appropriate place, person, or object from which knowledge of the monster can potentially be obtained. Sources could include:

- Hermits, scholars, or survivors
- Libraries, guilds, or records

Research the Secret. Once you have a source, spend hours equal to the monster's challenge rating researching or consulting. Make an ability check (DC = 10 + monster's CR):

- **Arcana:** Aberration, Construct, Elemental, Fey, Monstrosity
- **Nature:** Beast, Dragon, Ooze, Plant
- **Religion:** Celestial, Fiend, Undead
- **History:** Giant, Humanoid

If you succeed, don't forget to share what you discover with your trusted allies.

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MONSTER SECRETS